

Important Directions

- **Read through all slides**
 - **Watch all videos**

Thinking about Child Development: Current & Cultural Perspectives

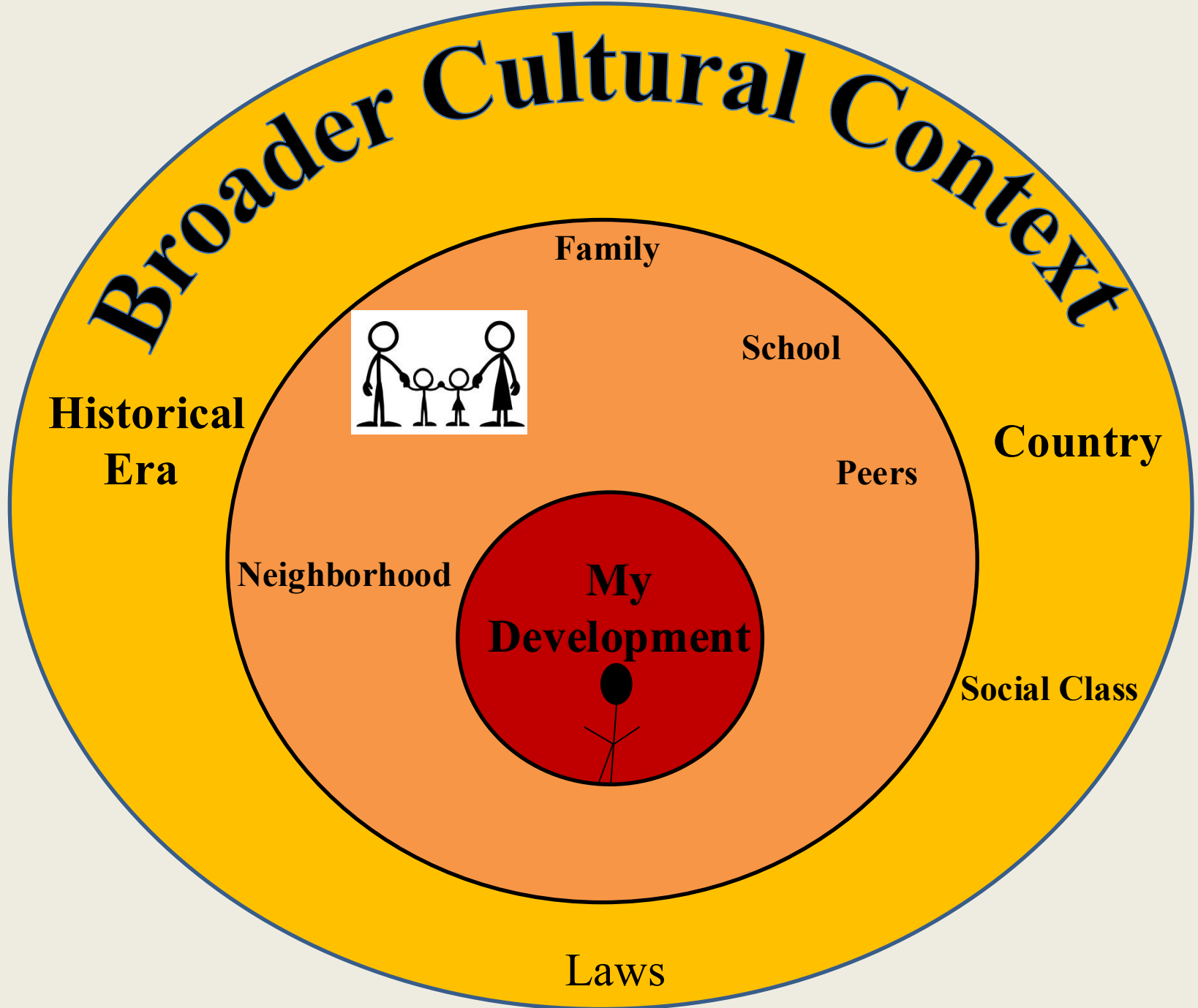


What makes up our culture?



Why we care about culture?

- Child Development– the way people grow and change from conception through emerging adulthood
 - Biological, cognitive, psychological, and social functioning
- Culture – the total pattern of a group's customs, beliefs, art, and technology, transmitted through language



Adapted from Ecological Systems Theory- Bronfenbrenner, 1979

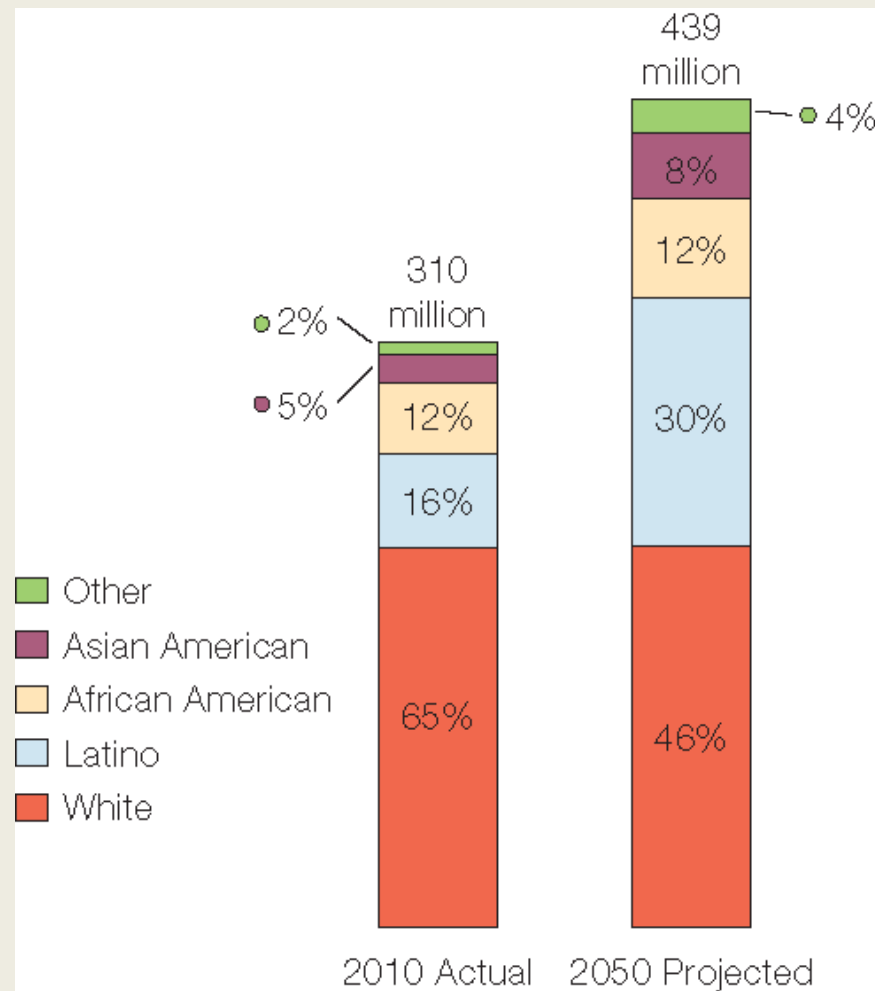
Culture is the context of Development

- The main staging area.
- The two are inseparable.
- Studying development without understanding the context is futile.

Question for thought

- Can you think of two child-rearing practices that you think differ across cultures (You can think about your personal experiences-your culture versus another culture)
- Feeding? Sleeping? Educational? Emotional Expression....?

Figure 1.2 Projected Ethnic Changes in the U.S. Population to 2050



As future professionals : We must understand the role of culture in development

- Nursing majors- May have patients from different cultural backgrounds
- Educators maybe working with students whose families have emigrated from other countries.
- Your friends, coworkers, neighbors may hail from varied cultural backgrounds.

Variations within countries

- SES- Socioeconomic Status

1. Parents educational level
2. Income level
3. Occupational status

Determines access to resources like health care and education

- Gender

- Continues to determine whether a child has access to resources like health care and education in many parts of the world

- Ethnicity- Race, Religion, Language

- Ethnic minorities within countries may have distinct cultural patterns that vary from the majority culture.

Beware of the single story

- Watch this TED talk on the importance of understanding human development and behavior by developing a “balance of stories”.
- https://www.ted.com/talks/chimamanda_ngozi_adichie_the_danger_of_a_single_story/c